The 32nd Degree – Master of the Royal Secret



The cordon is worn from the right shoulder to the left hip and is four inches wide, doubled, black edged with white on the principal side and crimson on the other. At the point of the principal side is embroidered a red Teutonic cross with a silver double–headed eagle superimposed. On the crimson side, at the height of the heart, is embroidered a Teutonic cross in black.

The jewel of the order is a Teutonic cross of gold with arms frosted. In the center are the letters “XXXII°,” surrounded by a green wreath.

The apron is of white silk or velvet, twelve inches square, edged with two stripes of gold lace, each half an inch wide, and an inch apart, and fringed with gold. Between the stripes of lace is a stripe of black velvet. On the flap are embroidered six flags, three on each side, the lower one blue, the middle one red, and the upper one gold. On these, in the center, is a Teutonic cross of gold, and over that an eye of gold, surrounded by rays. On the cross, a black double–

headed eagle, with beak and claws of gold, holding a sword of gold, one claw on the hilt. On the body of the apron is the Tracing–Board of the degree in all the colors. The reverse side of the apron is of crimson silk or velvet. It is tied by a heavy cord of crimson silk.

DUTIES

A Soldier of the Light seeks truth and knowledge.
A Soldier of Freedom demands for the people free vote and voice and attains freedom of voice, vote and opinion for himself.
A Soldier of the True Religion combats spiritual tyranny with reason and truth.
A Soldier of the People encourages men to be self-reliant and independent.
A Soldier of Scottish Rite Masonry is zealous and ardent in the performance of his duties to God, his country, his family, his brethren and himself.

LESSONS

The human is ever interlaced with the Divine.
Only doctrines, faith or knowledge which bear in action are of value.
To work is to worship.

FOR REFLECTION

Do you endeavor to achieve the Royal Secret in your life and within yourself?

IMPORTANT SYMBOLS

The Camp, Lesser Tetractys, five pointed star, Greater Tetractys seven-pointed star, triple interlaced triangles, Trimurti (3-faced bust).

The degree of Master of the Royal Secret selects, clarifies and unifies into a single coherent doctrine all of the duties and Lesson of the preceding degrees. In it we continue our journey eastward in search of the Holy Doctrine of which the Royal Secret is the foundation. To unveil the symbolism of the ages is a journey backward in time to the basic truths known by the ancient sages. Once the truths are revealed, our special charge is to maintain them in their purity, passing them on to the future concealed in allegory and symbolism and revealing them only to worthy men.

Here we learn of the ancient Aryan religious doctrine. Pike believed it was the earliest religion. It was his opinion that these teachings were corrupted and elaborated until the true meaning was lost. The name “Aryan” derives from the Sanskrit word for “noble.” They were a prehistoric tribe of central Asia which settled both Iran and northern India. From their language has descended, not only ancient Persian and Sanskrit, as well as their derivatives, but also most of the languages of Europe, including English.

One of Pike’s major sources on these people was the 19th century German orientalist Max Müller, the father of comparative linguistics. Müller believed that the religions and languages of Europe, Persia and India descended from these Asiatic tribes and that the key to this historical unity resided in the comparative study of languages. This is the reason for the detailed discussions on word origins to be found, especially in the *Readings* and *Legenda* for this degree. Müller’s over-reliance on data from languages rather than including other, equally important, cultural factors resulted in many errors which must be forgiven such an important pioneer in a largely untried field. Pike, however, has occasionally forwarded these errors. Therefore, his comments on the Aryans in the ritual must be considered an historical glimpse into the state of knowledge in the 19th century.

We have no texts from which to seek an understanding of the Aryan’s religious beliefs; and, therefore, we must look for common threads between the religions of pre-Islamic Persia and India. Since both received the influence of Aryan doctrine, what they share in common may be fairly presumed to have been derived from the Aryans. The main sources for this procedure have been the Persian *Zend–Avesta* and the Hindu Vedas.

Persian Doctrine: The probable source of the dualism in Western religions, including Christianity, is the ancient religion taught by Zoroaster of Persia (about 600 B.C.). This faith was an almost pure monotheism, rare at that time in the history of man. Zoroaster defined the universe as imbued with two forces: *Spenta Mainyu* or Holy Spirit (the force of truth) and Angra Mainyu, a

destructive spirit opposed to truth. These forces contended for influence over man but Zoroaster believed in free will—that man was able to choose between good and evil and was responsible for the consequences of his choice. These forces, and the actions which result from them, were but manifestations of the Principles of Good and Evil. The Principle of Good, the Supreme Being of this faith, was termed *Ahura Mazda* whom the Greeks called *Ormuzd*; in *Morals and Dogma* Pike uses both terms interchangeably.

The actions of *Ahura Mazda* were manifested through a hierarchy of subordinate spirits that are parallel to, and possibly the source of, the concept of angels in the Western religious tradition. These spirits were termed the *Amesha Spentas* or "Bounteous Immortals." Opposed to *Ahura Mazda* was *Ahriman* as the Principle of Evil. Many scholars have seen the origin of the Hebrew concept of Satan in this Persian doctrine. He also had his subsidiary created spirits. Both the good and evil spirits found expression in the faith and typified various virtues and vices. The celibate and/or monastic life was strongly forbidden as an evil violation of the imperatives of nature. The Zoroastrians saw the duality of the universe mirrored in the natural world but, unlike many later faiths, never juxtaposed the spiritual and material domains as good and evil respectively. Nature was good since all matter was the creation of *Ahura Mazda*. Life was to be lived, enjoyed and made fruitful.

Hindu Doctrine: We also find in the ritual a recitation of the beliefs of the Hindus of India. Having gained many of their beliefs from the Aryans in the northwest, Hindu doctrine reflects some of the early Persian religion that preceded Zoroaster. Hinduism seems at first to be an unremitting polytheism but the deities of the Hindu pantheon spring from a single source: the indescribable and unutterable *Brahm*. This conception of Deity is as profound and elevated as any to be found in the world. From this ineffable Deity comes the manifestations of physical reality: light, and its counterpart shadow or darkness; *Brahma*, the Creator; *Vishnu*, the preserver; and *Shiva*, the destroyer. This single process of creation, preservation and destruction revealed the cyclic nature of the universe

and led, quite naturally, to the concept of reincarnation. Virtue controlled the consequences of rebirth. Man, by a virtuous life, could look forward to rebirths that would give him a successively greater spiritual awareness and understanding; eventually he could be freed entirely from the cycle of rebirth and united with *Brahm*. Vice, on the other hand, led to lower births and by such actions a man might be reborn as a serpent or an insect.

The light which emanated from *Brahm* itself became deified as *Agni*, the god of light and fire whose name lives on in the English word “ignite.” Other natural phenomena underwent a similar process. The dawn became *Usha. Mitra*, anciently the Morning Star, became associated with the planet Venus; Herodotus calls this deity a female. Later, it became a male associated with the bull. The important point is that originally all three Vedic deities, *Agni, Usha* and Mitra were connected with the concept of light in some form. Pike believed the Hindu mantra, AUM, to be an anagram composed of the initials of these deities.

The Hindus were not dualist and had no Principle of Evil corresponding to the Persian Ahriman. They nonetheless associated, as Masons do, light with knowledge. Light was existence and thus reality. It is by light that man sees and understands the world around him; thus the Sanskrit root for “to see,” *vid*, became also the root for “knowledge.” This is preserved even in English where we have such words as “video” and “wit” both related to the Sanskrit *vid*. This root also has a secondary meaning of “find a husband” or “marry.” The husband was so important in the marriage relationship that the light truly went out of the life of a widow (from *wid–wa*; literally, in Sanskrit “without husband”) and we see arising the custom of the wife throwing herself upon her husband’s funeral pyre. By this practice the husband and wife would be joined together into a single light, to ascend together to become a single intellect, shining like a star forever. This practice, for the most part, was ended when the British assumed legal control over India in 1857.

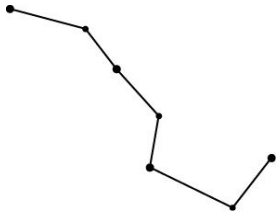
With this foundation from the Zoroastrian and Hindu doctrines, let us now begin our passage through time and space with an explanation of the Chamber of

Consistory, the name by which bodies of Inspectors Inquisitor and Masters of the Royal Secret are called, focusing on the many symbols illustrated there.

CEREMONY

Purple, red, gold and silver predominate in the colors of the set. The hangings are purple and gold, the altar cover is purple with Sanskrit letters in gold—the letters of the mystic Hindu mantra AUM. Also on the altar is a nine–pointed star formed from three interlaced gold triangles.

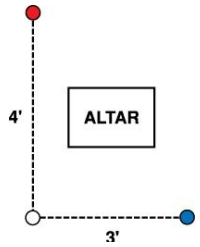
In the East is a chair reached by ascending seven steps separated into groups of three and four. These numbers are symbolic of many meanings in this degree:



- the sides of a perfect Pythagorean right triangle which form the right angle, being of a proportion of three to four units of measure;
- the seven stars of the constellation *Ursa Major* which became the *Amesha Spenta* or “Bounteous Immortal Ones” of the Persian creed, four male and three female—these in turn became the seven archangels of the Hebrew theology mentioned in the Degree of Knight of the Sun;
- the seven liberal arts and sciences divided into the Trivium (Grammar, Rhetoric, Logic) and the Quadrivium (Arithmetic, Geometry, Music and Astronomy);
- the color spectrum which derived from passing a ray of light through a prism and results in seven different colors which are grouped into the three lower colors—red, orange and yellow—and the four higher colors: green, blue, indigo and violet. We see these on the cover illustration of this book representing the division of light (knowledge) into its constituent parts (the individual subject matter of knowledge).

In the West two Lieutenant Commanders sit on chairs covered with crimson cloth and fringed in silver. Two triangular tables each covered with a crimson cloth, upon which is a Sanskrit letter of silver, are placed in front of these Chairs of State. On one is pure water and on the other a censer and vessels with incense and alcohol.

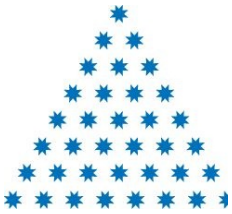
Purple has long been a color symbolizing the regal and noble; gold is a color associated with the Deity and derives from the color of the sun. Within the Consistory these colors are a statement of celestial and heavenly things and, specifically, of the omnipresent and omnipotent Deity. Red is indicative of the earthly realm, as is silver, which is the color frequently associated with the moon, a reflector of sunlight. In combination these colors are a reminder of a teaching of the 28th Degree—what is above is like what is below.



Around the Altar of Obligation are three large lights. They are placed to indicate the corners of a right angled triangle with a base of three measures, a perpendicular from the base of four measures and a hypotenuse of five measures; it is a representation of the Pythagorean right triangle– a symbol of the beauty in perfection, balance and proportion.

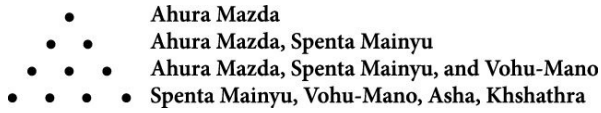
The Lesser Tetractys, a triangular form of ten lights seen in many preceding degrees, is situated between the altar and the West. Its apex also points to the East. This symbol is composed of dots; in this case ten, arranged in rows of one, two, three and four respectively. Within it may be traced the many symbols which have been explained in the preceding degree summaries, some of which have been used to design the jewels of various degrees. Pike’s interest in this symbol derives from its popularity with a wide variety of mystical schools. For the Pythagoreans it was a symbol of virtue. They swore their oaths upon it as we do the Bible and considered it the source of the eternal order of the world.

Thirty–six lights between the East and the altar form the Greater Tetractys of Pythagoras, its apex to the East. This symbol is composed of 36 dots arranged in eight rows of one, two, three, four, five, six, seven and eight dots respectively. Like the Lesser Tetractys, it was revered by the Pythagoreans because of the many symbols which could be created within it by connecting various combinations of dots. In the 32nd Degree Pike has given this symbol a Persian significance; that is, each line of dots represents respectively *Ahura Mazda* and the Amesha Spentas which were His manifestations. We also may see that there are a total of 48 smaller triangles which may be created by connecting all the dots. Twenty–seven have their apex pointing upwards and twenty–one have their apex pointing downward. Both of these numbers are multiples of three and were of special significance to the Pythagoreans.

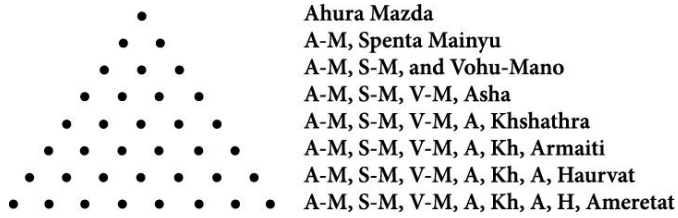


Pike believed that Pythagoras learned of the Tetractys from the Babylonian Magi and that the Jewish Kabbalists learned of it also from them during the 70 years of captivity mentioned in the 15th and 16th degrees but misunderstood its meaning. From its ten dots they created ten emanations of Deity when the Magi had only seven.

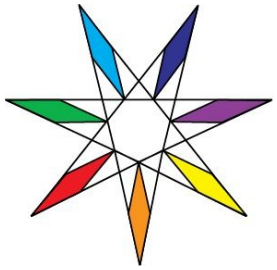
To the Magi the first three Tetractys rows included the previous row and then added one more; the final row representing the four male emanations, thus:



The Greater Tetractys was used to elaborate this idea to include all of the “Bountiful Immortals” in the design:



The three–faced bust is a symbol of the Trinity of Zarathustra and Pythagoras. Its Hindu character reminds us of the *Trimurti:* the expression of Deity in a threefold manifestation. In recent Hindu thought they are called Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva and represent the cyclical concepts of creation, preservation and destruction. You will remember that anciently this trinity was called *Agni, Usha* and *Mitra*; the anagram for which, AUM, is seen in the triple interlaced triangle. Again it should be stressed that these concepts are here to remind us of the universality of the great religious truths of man.



The Great Symbol, not seen in previous degrees, hangs in the East. It is a seven–pointed star containing within the points the three lower and four higher colors within a ray of light and visible when the light is passed through a prism. The seven points of this star represent the seven *Amesha Spenta* or "Bountiful Immortals" of the Persian creed, said to have been the source of the emanations of Deity termed by the Kabbalists the *Sephiroth*. Their origin may have been the seven stars of the constellation Ursa Major which naturally divide into the four which form the body and the three which form the tail. Three are female and four are male and they answer to the following qualities:

AHURA MAZDA, the Creator

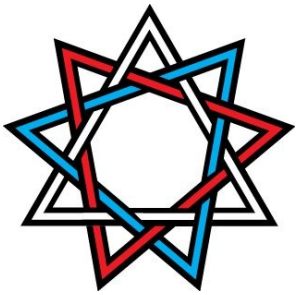
Male:

1) Spenta Mainyu, the Beneficent;
2) Vohu–mano, Divine Wisdom or the Word;
3) Asha, Strength & Power; Visible, the Fire;
4) Khshathra, Sovereignty and Dominion;

Female:

5) Armaiti, the Fruitful;

6) Haurvat, brings healing, happiness & rejoicing to men;
7) Ameretat, the Giver of Life.



In the West are transparencies of the triple interlaced triangles in the colors white, red and blue and a vermilion five–pointed star of triangles. At one level of abstraction, the triple interlaced triangles simply represent that Trinitarian concept so common in the world's major faiths. This concept is explained in the lecture for the 26th Degree, "Prince of Mercy," contained in *Morals and Dogma*, and so need not be repeated here. The colors of the triangles correspond to many different, but related, ideas. To the alchemist blue, red and white may represent certain qualities or materials, to the Kabbalists something else entirely. For a Master of the Royal Secret red denotes the material aspect of man, positively the virtue of zeal, negatively the vice of anger. Blue denotes the spiritual aspect of man, reflected in that canopy of all lodges and the earth itself, beckoning man's eyes and thoughts heavenward toward that divine source and inspiration for all our actions as Masons—the unfolding awareness of the divine plan for man. Blue is mystically darkness made visible. Thus, on the cover of this book the "bridge to light" spans the blue water, the darkness visible of ignorance and superstition. White represents the soul itself, reflecting the purity of its original state and demanding of us the highest standards of conduct. The interlacing of the triangles, like the interlacing of the lines which form the pentagram in the Knight of the Sun Degree brings to mind the interconnectedness of the material and spiritual world. The human is ever interlaced with the Divine, perhaps best expressed in man by the divine gift of reason. When mediated by faith, reason creates that harmony which is, in fact, the Royal Secret itself.



The five–pointed Star, with all its lines united, represents *Ahura* and the four male Emanations, and every cross represents these four.

The ceiling of the Chamber is the color of the sky. Painted on it, in specific locations, are the seven planets of the ancients—the sun, moon, Mercury, Venus, Jupiter, Saturn and Mars—and certain stars and constellations important to the ancients.

Beneath the symbolic sky is The Camp, the most notable and intricate symbol within this degree, representing an imaginary Masonic camp. It may be a painting like on a tracing board or an actual representation made with wood, tents and banners. Five geometric forms are clearly outlined from the center outward—the circle, equilateral triangle, pentagon, heptagon and nonagon. The number of sides of each geometric figure correspond to the sacred numbers of Pythagoras—one, three, five, seven and nine. The Masons from the 1st through the 18th degrees are encamped on the sides of the nonagon with a specific flag assigned to each encampment and located on an angle; each angle is also assigned a letter. On the pentagon, at each angle, is a letter and a Standard; the camps of the 19th through the 30th degrees are on the sides. Upon the five standards are the lion, eagle, ox or bull, the radiant heart of man and the Hebrew Ark of the Covenant.

Camped on the sides of the triangle are the Inspectors Inquisitor of the 31st Degree and the Masters of the Royal Secret. A raven, a dove and a phoenix are displayed on the angles. The raven is symbolic of justice and necessity and the dove represents mercy and liberty which produce in God and Nature, the Light, the Immortality and the victorious Glory, of which the Phoenix is the symbol; and these three, like the three sides of the Triangle of our Camp, are Unity (*Legenda* XXXII, p. 20).

The old rituals tell us that the third side is for the camp of those Knights of Malta who have proven themselves true and faithful. Legend tells us that the possessions of the Knights Templar, seized under the Papal Bull of 1312, which ultimately resulted in the death of Jacques de Molay, were distributed to the Knights of Rhodes, formerly Knights of St. John, who later became the Knights of Malta. Their acceptance of the Templar possessions generated hostility against the Knights of Malta. The camp reserved for their use is both a reminder of one of the greatest Templar martyrs, Jacques de Molay, and of the devastating effects of political and religious tyranny. More importantly, it reminds us of that particular duty of forgiveness: even the Knights of Malta who are true and faithful are reserved a place in the Camp.

Within the circle, a symbol of Deity and the number one, is a St. Andrew's Cross, which was discussed in detail in the 29th Degree. Camped at the intersection of the two lines that form this cross is the Grand Commander of the Rite and on the arms of the cross are the four Inspectors General who are invested with the dignity of Marshals. The accompanying fold–out illustrates the camp scene and summarizes the important symbols, mottoes and duties.

The candidate enters this darkened, but resplendent, scene for his consecration as a Master of the Royal Secret in the attire of a Knight Kadosh. He is described as a lover of knowledge and a coveter of wisdom in order to be a benefactor of men. He must affirm his interest in the ancient symbols of Masonry which represent the great truths in philosophy and religion. He declares that the law of his daily life is the exalted morality of Masonry. To understand these truths, the candidate is reminded:

You are here to think, if you can think; to learn, if you can learn.

The first instruction concerns the Deity and his relationship to men. We learn that the Deity created the universe by wisdom and a thought, that the universe consists of contraries and opposing forces, that God is the one light that fills all spaces and that He is man's protector. These statements are among the principal ideas in the religions of the world and come from early Hindu and Persian

religions about 6000 B.C. through the religion of Islam about 600 A.D., encompassing ideas from other major religions.

As the dawn appears the special symbol of this degree becomes clearly visible. The Camp, a complex symbol, should remind us first that only doctrines, faith or knowledge which bear fruit in action are of value to man. To become a Master of the Royal Secret is to bind ourselves tenfold more strongly to observe and keep all the obligations taken in the preceding degrees. While the candidate is conducted through the Camp, the duties and lessons associated with the degrees encamped on the nonagon and pentagon are briefly reviewed. The symbolic meaning of the images on the great standards of the 18th through 30th Degrees on the pentagon and the raven, dove and eagle of the triangle are hinted at, but left unstated the camp is a symbol which brings us face to face with images of the prophet Ezekiel and the Apocalypse to St. John: the lion, ox, man and eagle. We hear again the need for study and thought because Masonry is not only a sphinx, but a sphinx buried in the sand which the centuries have heaped around it.

Voices from the ancient past, in a re–creation of the supposed ceremonies of the Indo–Aryans and Irano–Aryans at the vernal equinox, teach us of the beneficence of the Deity. From Him come all good thoughts, good works, good deeds, strength, power, sovereignty, dominion, healing, happiness, immortality and victories. To Him we must give prayer, praise and adoration.

As the full light of day encompasses the Consistory, the candidate progresses from being a Knight Kadosh, a symbol of the practical nature of Masonry, to a Magus, or sage, the seeker of knowledge. He vows to be a Soldier of the Light. As light and truth were synonymous terms to the ancient Aryans because light makes the unreal become real, so a Soldier of the Light is a seeker of truth and knowledge. Ignorance is mental darkness which holds man in bondage like the walls of a prison or a shroud of stone. To become both priest and king, like all those who before have been entrusted with the Holy Doctrine and the Royal Secret, is to learn to exercise dominion over ourselves with wisdom. The priest is a symbol of divine wisdom, and the king, of divine sovereignty. Wisdom is

attainable through knowledge, not of the sciences, but of the great truths of religion and philosophy revealed in the stars and in nature, for nature is the Book of the Deity Himself. A Soldier of Light binds himself to learn, and to teach others, the great truths. From these truths we understand what God and nature are and what we are. They lift us to the realm of intellectual independence.

In becoming a Soldier of Freedom we learn that power, like all good in the world, comes from the Deity. Power contains within itself something of the sacred and is good unless corrupted. When corrupted, it becomes an evil principle expressing itself as despotism, the reduction of the life of all to the profit of one and the invasion of one into the life of all. It necessarily must proscribe free speech, consideration and justice. A true Soldier of Freedom, in demanding free voice and vote for the people in public affairs, will himself become free and remain master of his own voice, vote and opinion.

In man is a minute part of the divine intelligence which we call the intellect. The intellect, conscious of its origin, always instinctively turns to its origin, making man a religious being. To be a Soldier of the True Religion is to recognize the corruption of the true religion given to man. Thus, we must combat, with reason and truth, all spiritual tyranny over the souls and consciences of men. Finally, we war against all who would, with superstition, bigotry and fanaticism, prescribe what men may believe.

A Soldier of the People is one who protects the people from the unfit and incompetent who seek to gain power and become the leaders of the people by unworthy means. Since people everywhere desire a leader, they are often deceived by those unworthy and incapable of true leadership. To encourage men to be self–reliant and independent to such an extent that they will not blindly follow any leader is the duty of a loyal Soldier of the People.

A true Soldier of the Light, of Freedom, of the true Religion and of the People unites himself with others who are devoted to the same purpose as a Soldier of Scottish Rite Freemasonry. In doing so, we promise to perform faithfully and diligently all the duties of a Scottish Rite Mason, recognizing that to work is to worship. The special enemy to be fought within ourselves and others is inaction.

Let us ever recognize that men, by nature, are capable of greed and selfishness and many of the faults of men are not curable. We must take men as God has made them and the world as He has made it, making the best we can of all. A Soldier of Scottish Rite Masonry is zealous and ardent in his duty and armed with persuasion, not force, to combat the laggards and apathetic who see nothing in Masonry to do. We must become sovereign over ourselves, king of our own passions, neither intoxicated by success nor depressed by defeat, always remembering not to hate error so much as not to love mankind.

As Masters of the Royal Secret we must: perform our duties to God, our country, our family, our brethren and ourselves; achieve equilibrium in our lives and attitudes, always recognizing that within all men is a minute ray of that Divine Intellect which created the universe; remember that in man is God, and that man is indestructible and immortal. Such are the great lessons of Scottish Rite Freemasonry!

To be consecrated to these great lessons is to become a sage to be welcomed among the Masters of the Royal Secret who, let not the ray of divine light within be darkened by vice, indulgence and the passions, prefer exertion over ease, self denial for the good of others over luxury, knowledge and truth over wealth, and seek the approval of their own conscience over place and honors bestowed by others; and to join the great Masonic fraternity in which we all teach, incite, encourage, defend and protect our brethren from evil ways.

LECTURE

The Royal Secret, of which the holder of the 32nd Degree is a Prince, is no secret in the normal sense of the word; that is, it is not something to be hidden from the rest of the world. Here the word “Secret” should be understood as synonymous with the word “Mystery,” hidden only because we do not completely understand it. We are Princes of this Secret in the sense that the search for it is (or should be) a major goal in our lives. It is not a search distinct from the rest of our activities and therefore a distraction or a burden. Rather it is a search that is part of our lives. We search for it in our relationship with God,

our family, our vocation, and our brethren. It is not a vague ephemeral quest but a realizable goal which can, and should, be made the activity of our lives.

THIS ROYAL SECRET IS "EQUILIBRIUM"

By the word "equilibrium" we mean the harmony or balance which all of nature demonstrates to us and which is a guide for right living. We must respect others but must also have self–respect; we must give time to our families but preserve a portion for solitude; we must live this life but prepare for another. The well–lived life is a rush of contraries: work, relaxation; joy, sadness; thought, action.

The Royal Secret:

It is the secret of the Universal Equilibrium.

—Of that Equilibrium in the Deity, between the Infinite Divine WISDOM and the Infinite Divine POWER, from which result the Stability of the Universe, the unchangeableness of the Divine Law, and the Principles of Truth, Justice, and Right which are a part of it; and the Supreme Obligation of the Divine Law upon all men, as superior to all other law, and forming a part of all the laws of men and nations.

—Of that Equilibrium also, between the Infinite Divine JUSTICE and the Infinite Divine MERCY, the result of which is the Infinite Divine EQUITY, and the Moral Harmony or Beauty of the Universe. By it the endurance of created and imperfect natures in the presence of a Perfect Deity is made possible; and for Him, also, as for us, to love is better than to hate, and Forgiveness is wiser than Revenge or Punishment.

—Of that Equilibrium between NECESSITY and LIBERTY, between the action of the DIVINE Omnipotence and the Free–will of man, by which vices and base actions, and ungenerous thoughts and words are crimes and wrongs, justly punished by the law of cause and consequence, though nothing in the Universe can happen or be done contrary to the will of God; and without which co–

existence of Liberty and Necessity, of Free–will in the creature and Omnipotence in the Creator, there could be no religion, nor any law of right and wrong, or merit and demerit, nor any justice in human punishments or penal laws.

—Of that Equilibrium between Good and Evil, and Light and Darkness in the world, which assures us that all is the work of the Infinite Wisdom and of an Infinite Love; and that there is no rebellious demon of Evil, or Principle of Darkness co–existent and in eternal controversy with God, or the Principle of Light and of Good; by attaining to the knowledge of which equilibrium we can, through Faith, see that the existence of Evil, Sin, Suffering, and Sorrow in the world, is consistent with the Infinite Goodness as well as with the Infinite Wisdom of the Almighty.

—Of that Equilibrium between Authority and Individual Action which constitutes Free Government, by settling on immutable foundations Liberty with Obedience to Law, Equality with Subjection to Authority, and Fraternity with Subordination to the Wisest and the Best: and of that Equilibrium between the Active People, and the Passive Stability and Permanence of the Will of the Past, expressed in constitutions of government, written or unwritten, and in the laws and customs, gray with age and sanctified by time, as precedents and authority; which is represented by the arch resting on the two columns, Jachin and Boaz, that stand at the portals of the Temple builded by Wisdom, on one of which Masonry sets the celestial Globe, symbol of the spiritual part of our composite nature and on the other the terrestrial Globe, symbol of the material part.

—And, finally, of that Equilibrium, possible in ourselves, and which Masonry incessantly labors to accomplish in its Initiates, and demands of its Adepts and Princes (else unworthy of their titles), between the Spiritual and Divine and the Material and Human in man; between the Intellect, Reason, and Moral Sense on one side, and the Appetites and Passions on the other, from which result the Harmony and Beauty of a well–regulated life.

Which possible Equilibrium proves to us that our Appetites and Senses also are Forces given unto us by God, for purposes of good, and not the fruits of the malignancy of a Devil, to be detested, mortified, and, if possible, rendered inert and dead: that they are given us to be the means by which we shall be strengthened and incited to great and good deeds, and are to be wisely used, and not abused; to be controlled and kept within due bounds by the Reason and the Moral Sense; to be made useful instruments and servants, and not permitted to become the managers and masters, using our intellect and reason as base instruments for their gratification.

And this Equilibrium teaches us, above all, to reverence ourselves as immortal souls, and to have respect and charity for others, who are even such as we are, partakers with us of the Divine Nature, lighted by a ray of the Divine Intelligence, struggling, like us, toward the light; capable, like us, of progress upward toward perfection, and deserving to be loved and pitied, but never to be hated nor despised; to be aided and encouraged in this life–struggle, and not to be abandoned nor left to wander in the darkness alone, still less to be trampled upon in our own efforts to ascend.

Such, my Brother, is the TRUE WORD of a Master Mason; such the true ROYAL SECRET, which makes possible, and shall at length make real, the HOLY EMPIRE of true Masonic Brotherhood.

GLORIA DEI EST CELARE VERBUM. AMEN (pp. 859–861).

The 32nd Degree Camp

Camp Locations, Degrees and Important Lessons or Duties:



NONAGON

Banner Letter: IS

Color/Design: Blue

1. **Aprentices:** *Ignorance makes man helpless and blind.*
2. **Fellowcrafts**: *Knowledge enable men to become free.*
3. **Master Masons:** *Immortality of the Soul*

Banner Letter: N

Color/Design: Green

4. **Secret Masters:** *Practice silence, obedience and fidelity.*
5. **Perfect Masters:** *Do that which is right because it is right.*

Banner Letter: O

Color/Design: Red/Green

6. **Intimate Secretaries:** *Be zealous and act the peacemaker*.
7. **Provosts and Judges:** *Judge impartially and mercifully.*

Banner Letter: N

Color/Design: Red/Black

8. **Intendants of the Building:** *Every laboring man is our brother.*

Banner Letter: X

Color/Design: Black

9. **Elus of the Nine:** *Pledge yourself to the cause of freedom.*

10. **Elus of the Fifteen:** *Be tolerant and liberal.*

11. **Elus of the Twelve:** *Be earnest, true and reliable.*

Banner Letter: I

Color/Design: Black/Red

12. **Master Architects:** *Become a seeker of wisdom.*

13. **Masons of the Royal Arch:** *Be motivated by duty and honor.*

Banner Letter: L

Color/Design: Red

14. **Perfect Elus:** *Perfect Elus are both bound and free.*

Banner Letter: A

Color/Design: Light Green

15. **Knights of the East:** *Freedom of thought, speech and action.*

16. **Princes of Jerusalam**: *Follow the Masonic Truth.*

Banner Letter: S

Color/Design: White/Crimson

17. **Knights of the East and West:** *Seek the light of Masonic Philosophy.*

18. **Knights Rose Croix:** *Evil is reconcilable with God's beneficence.*

HEPTAGON (NO CAMPS)

PENTAGON

Banner Letter: U

Color/Design: Ark of the Covenant

19. **Grand Pontiffs:** *Labor for the good of those who follow you.*

20: **Masters of the Symbolic Lodge:** *Be both a leader and a teacher. Motto: Praise Be To God.*

Banner Letter: G
Color/Design: Ox (Bull)
21. **Prussian Knights:** *Have faith in the power of Right.*
22. **Knights Royal Axe:** *Work is the mission of man. Motto: Time Gives Growth and Strength to All Things.*

Banner Letter: N
Color/Design: Eagle with Sword and Bloody Heart
23. **Chiefs of the Tabernacle:** *Faith is wiser than vain philosophy.*
24. **Princes of the Tabernacle:** *Faith in the Deity is powerful.*
25. **Knights of the Brazen Serpent:** *Each must re-create himself by knowledge. Motto: Strong of Heart and with the Sword.*

Banner Letter: E
Color/Design: Flaming and Winged Heart
26. **Princes of Mercy:** *All religions possess some Truth.*
27. **Knights of the Sun:** *Virtue has been the same in all times.*
28. **Commanders of the Temple:** *The visible manifests then invisible. Motto: Inflamed with Glory It Ascends.*

Banner Letter: T
Color/Design: Lion with Key
29. **Knights of St. Andrew:** *The great cycle of time is but change.*
30. **Knights Kadosh:** *Great examples are the legacy of the past. Motto: To the Greater Glory of God.*

TRIANGLE

Banner Letter: none
Color/Design: Dove, Phoenix, Raven
31. **Inspector Inquisitor:** *Justice and mercy unite in equity.*

32. **Master of the Royal Secret, Faithful Knights of Malta:** *Achieve equilibrium in your life.*

CIRCLE

33. **Inspectors General**

ST. ANDREWS CROSS

Grand Ctommander and Inspectors General invested as Marshalls.